

KOTA MEGHANA

Ph.D. Scholar — Floriculture & Landscape Architecture | ICAR-IIHR, Bengaluru

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ACADEMIC PROFILE

Research-oriented horticulture professional specializing in Floriculture and Landscape Architecture, with doctoral research experience in agrivoltaics, ornamental crop production, protected cultivation, plant physiological responses, and energy-use efficiency. Experienced in experimental research, microclimate monitoring, scientific data interpretation, technical writing, and academic presentations.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Qualified ASRB-NET in Floriculture and Landscaping (2024).
- Secured AIR-13 in ICAR-SRF (PGS), 2023.
- Awarded IARI Fellowship for doctoral studies.
- Best Research Paper Award — Global Conference (2025).
- Best Poster Presentation Award — National Conference (2024).

EDUCATION

Qualification	Institution	Year	Score
Ph.D. (Floriculture & Landscape Architecture)	ICAR-Indian Institute of Horticultural Research, Hessarghatta, Bengaluru	2023–Present	9.01 (Pursuing)
M.Sc. Horticulture (Floriculture & Landscape Architecture)	Dr. YSR Horticultural University, College of Horticulture, Venkataramannagudem, West Godavari, AP	2022	8.74
B.Sc. (Hons.) Horticulture	Dr. YSR Horticultural University, College of Horticulture, Venkataramannagudem, West Godavari, AP	2020	8.45
Intermediate	Board of Intermediate Education, NRI Arts and Science Junior College, Guntur, AP	2016	97.2%
Secondary Education (CBSE)	Sri Venkateswara Bala Kuteer, Syamalanagar, Guntur, AP	2014	10.00 CGPA

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Agrivoltaics in ornamental crops • Protected cultivation • Floriculture and ornamental horticulture • Landscaping • Plant physiological responses

DOCTORAL RESEARCH

“Studies on influence of agrivoltaics on crop productivity and energy efficiency in ornamental crops.”

- Evaluating effects of altered light conditions on crop growth, physiology, yield, and energy generation/energy-use efficiency under a tailored agrivoltaics system.
- Monitoring and recording microclimate, physiological, and soil changes under agrivoltaics systems.

M.SC. RESEARCH

“Influence of growth retardants on growth and flowering of crossandra under field and potted conditions.”

- Studied the impact of specific growth retardants on growth and yield of an important loose flower crop under South Indian conditions.

RESEARCH PUBLICATIONS

Authors	Year	Title	Journal / Details
Meghana K, DVS Raju, AVD Dorajee Rao, M Ravindra Babu, P Subbramamma	2025	Influence of growth retardants on growth and flowering of crossandra (<i>Crossandra infundibuliformis</i>) under field conditions	Plant Archives, Vol. 15(10): 1167–1169 (NAAS 5.5)
Meghana K, DVS Raju, AVD Dorajee Rao, M Ravindra Babu, P Subbramamma	2023	The Effect of Growth Inhibitors on the Growth, Roots, and Flowering Attributes of Crossandra in Pot	Biological Forum – An International Journal, Vol. 15(11): 36–38 (NAAS 5.23)
Meghana K, DVS Raju, AVD Dorajee Rao, M Ravindra Babu, P Subbramamma	2022	Influence of growth retardants on growth and flowering of Crossandra under potted conditions	The Pharma Innovation Journal, Vol. 11(8): 1302–1304 (NAAS 5.21)
Meghana K, Ratna Kumari N, Bharathi N	2024	The influence of Auxins on Rooting Process of Terminal Cuttings of Chrysanthemum (<i>Dendranthema grandiflora</i>)	Biological Forum – An International Journal, Vol. 11(8): 1302–1304 (NAAS 5.21)

BOOK CHAPTERS & POPULAR ARTICLES

- 3 book chapters, including “Container Gardening”; “India's Floral Industry – Present State and Prospects for Future”; and “Advances in Fragrance Breeding in Flower Crops.”
- 6 popular articles covering rooftop gardening, vase-life enhancement, water-wise landscaping/xeriscaping, saffron cultivation, snapdragon cultivation, and pest management.

CONFERENCE & SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

- Evaluating effect of Agrivoltaics on Peace Lily (*Spathiphyllum wallisii*): Growth, Productivity and Energy Generation — 11th Indian Horticulture Congress; abstract published.
- Optimizing Growth, Yield and Energy Generation: Impact of Agrivoltaics on Marigold Cultivation in Inter-Row and Inter-Panel Spaces — Global Conference; Best Research Paper Award.
- Evaluating effect of Agrivoltaics on Snapdragon Growth, Productivity and Energy Generation — International Conference; abstract published.
- Influence of various growth retardants on growth and vegetative parameters of crossandra under potted conditions — National Conference; Best Poster Presentation Award.
- Additional national/international seminar presentations and abstract publications in floriculture, agriculture, and sustainable horticulture.

TRAINING

- Statistical Methods for Research Data Analysis using R — ICAR-IIHR (2025).
- Ashwagandha Campaign cum Promotion of Medicinal Plants Cultivation — ICAR-IIHR (2025).
- Development of Soft Skills for Entrepreneurship among Agri Graduates — Dr. YSR Horticultural University (2020).

TEACHING & ACADEMIC COMPETENCIES

- Strong communication and presentation skills.
- Ability to explain technical concepts effectively.
- Experience in seminar presentations and academic discussions.
- Subject knowledge in floriculture, protected cultivation, and ornamental horticulture.
- Scientific writing and data interpretation skills.

TECHNICAL & COMPUTER SKILLS

Microsoft Office Suite (Word, Excel, PowerPoint) • Excel and R-Studio for data handling and analysis • Scientific writing and data interpretation • Computer Applications coursework during B.Sc. (Hort.)

FIELD EXPERIENCE

- Rural Horticulture Work Experience Programme (RHWEP): farmer interaction and dissemination of horticultural practices in vegetable and flower crops.
- Experiential Learning Programme: rearing and culturing of bio-inputs used for sustainable and eco-friendly pest management.

LANGUAGES

Telugu • English • Hindi • Kannada

SELECTED EXTRA-CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- Best Female Athlete, IARI-IIHR Annual Sports Meet — 2024 and 2026.
- Third place, Agriculture and Food Security category, Bengaluru Eco Summit 2024 (IISc Bengaluru — Haritvam).
- Participated in 18th All India Agri-sports Meet, University of Agricultural Sciences, Bengaluru (2018).
- Participated in 61st National School Games in Gymnastics, Ranga Reddy District, Telangana (2016).
- National Service Scheme Special Camp volunteer, 2017–18.

REFERENCES

Dr. Sridhar Gutam — Principal Scientist, ICAR-IIHR, Hessarghatta Lake Post, Bengaluru–560089 | sridhar.gutam@icar.org.in
Dr. D. V. S. Raju — Principal Scientist, ICAR-DFR, Regional Station, Vemagiri, Kadiyam Mandal, East Godavari–533124 | rajivalex@gmail.com